RUI (ZOE) HUANG

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ACADEMIC POSITION

2026 - present	Postdoctoral fellow, Seattle Children's Research Institute, University of Washington

EDUCATION

2026	Ph.D., Sociology, University at Buffalo, SUNY. *Dissertation:* That Which Does Not Kill Me Makes Me Stronger? Understanding Pain from the Life Course Perspective *Dissertation Committee*: Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk (Chair), Ashley Barr, Kristen Schultz Lee, Zachary Zimmer Qualifying Exams: Medical Sociology; Quantitative Method
2020	M.A., Sociology, University at Buffalo, SUNY.
2015	M.A., Human Resource Management, University of Leeds.
2014	B.M., Financial Management, Wuhan University of Technology.

AREAS OF SPECIALIZATION

Medical Sociology, Population Health, Demography, Aging and the Life Course, Quantitative Methods, Chronic Pain.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

Forthcoming	**Huang, Rui**, Yuhang Li, Zachary Zimmer, Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, and Tran Khanh Toan. "Early-Life War Exposure and Later-Life Chronic Pain in Vietnam: Risk, Resilience, and Timing." *Journal of Health and Social Behavior.*

Forthcoming Sun Feinuo, Akib Zaman, and **Rui Huang**. "Managing Existing Pain: Predicting Pain Progression and Recovery Using Machine Learning Approaches." Annals of Epidemiology

Forthcoming Anna Zajacova, **Rui Huang**, Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, Rui Li, and Lauren E. Harrison. "Chronic Pain Disparities by Sexual Identity and Sex/Gender: Intersectional Patterns and Pathways in a Nationally Representative US Sample" *American Journal of Public Health*.

Forthcoming Yuan, Yaqi, **Rui Huang**, and Yulin Yang. "Racial-Ethnic Differences in Healthcare Experience Among Middle-Aged and Older Adults in the United States: Evidence from Four Waves of the Health and Retirement Study." *Journal of Aging and Health*.

2026 Li, Rui, **Rui Huang**, Kavin Srinakarin, Anna Zajacova, Zachary Zimmer, Tonya Palermo, and Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk. "Country-Level Gender Inequality and Sex Disparities in Adolescent Chronic Pain: A 47-Country Analysis." *Preventive Medicine* 108495. doi:10.1016/j.ypmed.2026.108495.

2025 **Huang, Rui,** Yuhang Li, and Feinuo Sun. "Welfare Policies, Joint Pain Prevalence and Educational Gaps in 50 U.S. States from 2011 to 2021: A Fixed Effects Analysis." *Journal of Pain*. doi:10.1016/j.jpain.2025.105539.

2025 Yang, Yulin, Feinuo Sun, Zachary Zimmer, Anna Zajacova, **Rui Huang**, Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, and Jacqueline M. Torres. "Chronic Pain Prevalence and Trends in Urban, Suburban, and Rural Areas of American Adults Aged 55+, 1998-2022." *Social Science & Medicine* 385:118625. doi:10.1016/j.socscimed.2025.118625.

2025 Grol-Prokopczyk, Hanna, **Rui Huang**, Chang Yu, Yu-An Chen, Sirat Kaur, Merita Limani, Ting-Hui Lin, Anna Zajacova, Zachary Zimmer, Penney Cowan, and others. "Over Fifty Years of Research on Social Disparities in Pain and Pain Treatment: A Scoping Review of Reviews." *Pain* 24(10). doi:10.1097/j.pain.0000000000003676.
* "Editor's Choice" article.

2023 **Huang, Rui**, Yulin Yang, Anna Zajacova, Zachary Zimmer, Yuhang Li, and Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk. “Educational Disparities in Joint Pain within and across US States: Do Macro Sociopolitical Contexts Matter?” *Pain* 164(10):2358–69. doi:10.1097/j.pain.0000000000002945.

2022 **Huang, Rui**, and Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk. “Health and Health Behaviors in China: Anomalies in the SES-Health Gradient?” *SSM - Population Health* 17:101069. doi:10.1016/j.ssmph.2022.101069.

2022 Yang, Yulin, **Rui Huang**, Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, and Jacqueline M. Torres. "Social Network Change after New-Onset Pain among Middle-Aged and Older European Adults." *Social Science & Medicine* 310:115215. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.socscimed.2022.115215.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Forthcoming **Huang, Rui** and Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk. “Chronic Pain in Later Life.” In *Handbook of Aging and the Social Sciences,* 10th edition, edited by Kenneth F. Ferraro and Deborah Carr.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Huang, Rui, “Breaking the Long Arm of Childhood: How European Welfare States Shape the Association Between Childhood Disadvantage and Later-Life Pain.” (Under review)

Huang, Rui, “Stress resilience or stress proliferation? The impact of life course cumulative stress on chronic pain, interference, and multisite pain” (manuscript is available)

Yu, Chang, Mo Han, **Rui Huang**, Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, and Gongda Yu. “Human-Coded Reference vs. GPT-Based Models in Data Extraction for a Scoping Review of Reviews: Evaluating Accuracy Across Review and Task Types.” (R&R)

Yuan, Yaqi, **Rui Huang**, and Yulin Yang. “Socioeconomic Status and Healthcare Satisfaction among Middle-Aged and Older US Adults: A Mediation Analysis.” (under review)

Li, Yuhang and **Rui Huang.** “One country, two worlds: Hukou as an institutional context shaping hypertension management in China.”

HONORS & AWARDS

2026 Student Award, Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science (IAPHS)

2026 Travel Grant, the symposium "Place as method, theory, and responsibility: Rethinking scientific inquiry for complex social issues" at the University of Michigan Institute for Social Research

2026 2nd place recipients of the Nathalie Devine Howe Award for Outstanding Scholarship for the article "Stress resilience or stress proliferation? The impact of life course cumulative stress on chronic pain, interference, and multisite pain." ($700)

2023 Travel Grant, Department of Sociology and Criminology, University at Buffalo, SUNY. ($500)

2023 2nd place recipients of the Nathalie Devine Howe Award for Outstanding Scholarship for the article "One country, two worlds: Hukou as an institutional context shaping hypertension management in China." (with Yuhang Li)

2014 First Prize in Project Competition of Chartered Institute of Personnel and Development (CIPD), University of Leeds.

CONFERENCE AND INVITED* PRESENTATIONS

2026 "Unequal Beginnings, Unequal Pain: Three Approaches to How Welfare State Moderate the Relationship between Childhood Ses and Later-Life Pain". Presentation at the Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science, Portland, OR

2026 "Chronic Pain Disparities by Sexual Identity and Sex/Gender: Intersectional Patterns and Pathways in a Nationally Representative US Sample". Poster session presentation at the Population Association of America, St. Louis, MO.

2026 "Chronic Pain Disparities by Sexual Identity and Sex/Gender: Intersectional Patterns and Pathways in a Nationally Representative US Sample". Poster session presentation at the Population Association of America, St. Louis, MI.

2026 "Unequal beginnings, Unequal pain: Three approaches to how Welfare State moderate the relationship between childhood SES and later-life pain.". Presentation at the Family, Life Course, and Sociology of Health (FLASH)

Works-in-Progress group, Department of Sociology and Criminology, University at Buffalo, SUNY, NY.

2025* "Early-Life War Exposure and Later-Life Chronic Pain in Vietnam: Risk, Resilience, and Timing". Invited talk, Graduate Research Symposium, University at Buffalo, SUNY.

2025 "Early-Life War Exposure and Later-Life Chronic Pain in Vietnam: Risk, Resilience, and Timing". Poster session presentation at the Population Association of America, Washington DC.

2025* "Risk, Resilience and Timing: How does Early-Life War Exposure Shape Later-Life Chronic Pain in Vietnam?" Presentation at the Population Health and Conflict, the University of Utah.

2025 "Early-Life War Exposure and Later-Life Chronic Pain in Vietnam: Does the Timing of Exposure Matter?" Presentation at the Workshop on Determinants of Adult Mortality, Morbidity, and Healthy Aging in LMICs, UC Berkeley Center on the Economics and Demography of Aging (CEDA).

2024 "Welfare Policies and Joint Pain Across 50 US States – A Fixed Effect Analysis Using State-level Panel Data, 2011 – 2021". Presentation at the Demography of Chronic Pain Group, Department of Sociology, University at Buffalo, SUNY, NY.

2023 "Educational Disparities in Joint Pain within and across U.S. States: Do State Contexts Matter?". Poster session presentation at the Population Association of America, NO.

2022 "Social Network Change after New-Onset Pain among Middle-Aged and Older European Adults." Presentation at the Family, Life Course, and Sociology of Health (FLASH) Works-in-Progress group, Department of Sociology, University at Buffalo, SUNY, NY.

2022 "Health and Health Behaviors in China: Anomalies in the SES-Health Gradient?". Poster presentation at the Celebration of Academic Excellence, University at Buffalo, SUNY, NY.

2021 "Health in China." Guest lecture for SOC322 Medical Sociology, University at Buffalo, SUNY, NY.

MEDIA COVERAGE (SELECTED)

2026 "Childhood war exposure leaves lasting pain", UB News, February 5, 2026, https://www.buffalo.edu/news/releases/2026/02/rui-huang-war-exposure-chronic-pain.html

2025 "Social policies may reduce prevalence, disparities in arthritis-related joint pain", Healio, December 30, 2025, https://www.healio.com/news/rheumatology/20251229/social-policies-may-reduce-prevalence-disparities-in-arthritisrelated-joint-pain

2025 "State social policies reduce joint pain prevalence, according to UB study", UBNow, October 28, 2025, https://www.buffalo.edu/ubnow/stories/2025/10/joint-pain-social-policies.html

2023 "Got Arthritis Pain? What State You Live In May Matter", U.S. News & World Report, July 12, 2023, https://www.usnews.com/news/health-news/articles/2023-07-12/got-arthritis-pain-what-state-you-live-in-may-matter

2023 "Study: Pain risk varies significantly across states", July 7, 2023, SUNY at Buffalo News Center, https://www.buffalo.edu/news/releases/2023/07/huang-joint-pain.html

2023 "Research Update: Pain: Identifying Pain Early Proves a Cost Benefit Ratio for US Budgets", Global Aging & Community Initiative (GACI) newsletter, June, 2023, https://globalagingandcommunity.files.wordpress.com/2023/06/2.june-gaci-newsletter_2023.pdf

2022 "Study shows surprising results on association between wealth, education and health outcomes in China", SUNY at Buffalo News Center, May 5, 2022, https://www.buffalo.edu/news/releases/2022/05/006.html

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2026 Research Assistant for Dr. Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, Department of Sociology and Criminology, University at Buffalo, SUNY, Buffalo, U.S.

2025 Research Assistant for Dr. Anna Zajacova, Department of Sociology, Western University, London, Canada.

2024 Research Consultant for Dr. Feinuo Sun, Department of Kinesiology, The University of Texas at Arlington, Arlington, U.S.

2024 Research Assistant for Dr. Anna Zajacova, Department of Sociology, Western University, London, Canada.

2021 - 2022 Research Assistant for Dr. Hanna Grol-Prokopczyk, Department of Sociology and Criminology, University at Buffalo, SUNY, Buffalo, U.S.

TEACHING

Instructor:

SOC378: Social Inequality and Health

Teaching Assistant:

SOC504: Basic Statistics for the Social Science (graduate level)
SOC101: Introduction to Sociology
SOC322: Medical Sociology
SOC311: Drugs & Society
SOC357: Race, Crime & Criminal Justice

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ongoing Ad hoc reviewer for *Journal of Health and Social Behavior*, *Social Science & Medicine, SSM-Population Health, PLOS Global Public Health, Global Public Health, BMC Geriatrics, Social Science Research, European Spine Journal, AJPM Focus*

2026 Reviewer, 18th Consortium of Universities for Global Health (CUGH) annual Conference

2026 Mentor, American Sociological Association Medical Sociology mentoring program

2026 Nominations Committee, Student Member, Medical Sociology section in the American Sociological Association.

2026 Reviewer, 2026 Annual Meeting, Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science (IAPHS).

2024 - 2026 Member, Grievance Committee, College of Arts and Sciences, University at Buffalo, SUNY.

2019-2020 Sociology Graduate Student Association, University at Buffalo, SUNY.

2014-2015	Student Representative, Business School, Faculty Student Education Committees, University of Leeds.
2011-2014	Student Representative, Student Committee, Wuhan University of Technology.

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

American Sociological Association (Life Course and Aging; Medical Sociology; Methodology)
Population Association of America
Interdisciplinary Association for Population Health Science
Global Aging & Community Initiative
PURPOSE Pain Research Network
Population Health and Conflicts